

How to Divide Your Prayer Time

Go to John 16. I will not be very long, and when I am, believe me, I always do it with the best intentions.

The further you get into this, the better it gets. The more you learn about Him, fellowship with Him, and spend time in His presence, the better it gets. There is nothing any of us does that is taxing enough to keep us from entering into His presence.

One of the most powerful things we have for prayer is the name of Jesus. When you tag that onto your prayer and say, "Father, I ask this in Jesus' name," there is power in that name because of what it represents.

That name represents victory. It represents a finished work on the Cross. When you use the name of Jesus, you are asking in the name of the accomplished and finished work on the Cross. You are saying, "I use Your name, which represents the price You paid so I could have the answer to my prayer."

Those are the rights you have.

The prayer of petition is one of the most powerful prayers there is.

If I knew what I know now and was carrying on the job I had before I entered the ministry, for one thing, I would not have that job. If I were not called to preach, I would be smart enough now to make a whole lot more money doing a whole lot less work than I was doing then.

If I only had a certain amount of time to spend in the presence of God, say half a day on Saturday, then I would divide that time into three parts: praying in tongues, worship, and confession.

Now that I have learned more about confession from Ephesians 5, I link my confession together with worship. Worship brings the presence of God to your soul. It magnifies His presence in your spirit until you become more aware of spiritual things than natural things.

Worship brings His presence, and when His presence comes, it makes confession more enjoyable. Your confession does not turn into a dry, powdery puff from your breath.

If I only had five good hours to give Him, I would divide that time between tongues, worship, and confession, often blending worship and confession together.

God has done something here. When He said this message has come to maturity, that means it is going to be brought outside of this camp.

To tell you the truth, I believed intently that God was going to visit you with revival because He wanted me to take a group of sheep through to revival. That is my intention. But this last week, when He ministered to me, He made it clear that He is going to take this outside of this camp.

There is a group of people who will take it and ram it through.

I know how Satan works. He kicks up the most dust to see if he can convince you that what you see is not what you see. I have not been moved by him to this point, and I do not intend to start now.

God ministered to me, "This message has come to maturity. Turn it loose."

If I were you, I would get stronger than ever. I would be relentless, because God is going to pour something out on us.

In the day of reward, you will be intensely glad when you were faithful at a time when you could see no evidence, feel no evidence, and had no assurance outside His Word that there would ever be evidence. Yet you remained faithful until the fruit came.

Many will get on board when they can see it with their eyes. Thank God for the work they do after that, but there is a reward for faithfulness before the visible evidence.

My standard message, because you are edifying yourself, is to add understanding to your edification. Praying in tongues is one of the longest-term kinds of change.

When you begin steadily praying, you invest six months, then a year, and incredible change begins to come to the real problem.

Jesus said you can say to the mountain, "Be removed and cast into the sea," and if you doubt not in your heart, you will have what you say. The whole reason the mountain goes or does not go is based on whether you doubted in your heart.

If you want to know the real reason the mountain did not go, it is you.

It is easy to frame things and blame things. One of the greatest signs of weakness is justifying where you are and what you are doing in areas of failure. When we look for excuses for failure instead of reasons, we are not ready to change. We are more willing to justify than change.

Coming face to face with the responsibility of change is one of the first big steps into change.

If you are going to pray in tongues, you have accepted the responsibility to deal with the part of you that doubts in the heart.

The heart is the operation of the Spirit's ascendancy over the soul. To believe with the whole heart means the Spirit has ascendancy over the soul. Anytime you give your lifestyle to this kind of praying, you have decided on long-term change. You have decided to deal, on a lifetime basis, with the things that keep the mountain from moving.

There is a difference between assaulting a temporary problem and invoking God to solve it, which He will, and letting Him produce permanent change in your life.

It is like the difference between living from paycheck to paycheck and becoming a multimillionaire. Letting Him deal with your whole life is the millionaire side. Invoking Him day by day over temporary situations is necessary too, but it deals with immediate problems.

If you let Him deal with you in change, you begin to overcome the whole thing.

If a person takes a problem to God with confession, walking around the table speaking the Word over that problem, ministering to his own soul, the decision alone changes him enough to receive.

Even if there are horrible things in your life that should not be there, if you are willing to walk around the coffee table hundreds of times a night and speak His Word over what needs to be changed, there is faith in the obedience itself.

You are not going to spend that much time with God and not become concerned with other things in your life that need to change.

Any direction you take into prayer will be beneficial. If something immediate has come and you only have a few months to deal with it, confession addresses that immediate problem. Praying in tongues deals with edification and long-term change.

That kind of prayer will put you in a small percentage of believers in the Body of Christ, especially by the end of your life. The rest of the saints may wear you out because they will need what you have so badly.

People are looking for hope. Religion is not providing the answers many need inside. We can tolerate almost anything, but when forsakenness, loneliness, hopelessness, and defeat get inside, a person is finished.

When people see someone walking around with answers and some kind of light, they will flock to him because everyone is looking for answers.

If I only had a day a week, or half a day on Saturday, I would divide my time. When I link worship and confession together, it is different than just walking around saying something over and over.

I will worship God intensely until His anointing drops on me. Then I will speak His Word and keep speaking it, then revolve back into worship. That way His presence stays on me, and when I speak the Word of God, it is in fellowship in His presence.

Many times my worship and confession will go like this:

"I worship You and praise You. I glorify You and magnify You, Jesus. I love You. I adore You. I worship You. I praise You."

I would like to stand there and tell Him ten thousand times that I have fallen in love with Him.

Three of my favorite words are "Te amo." It means, "I love You," but it is not just saying "I love You." It is me collecting my whole soul together, not letting it wander down the street to solve problems from yesterday, and pouring everything my soul is, my mind, will, intellect, and emotions, into that simple statement: "I love You, Jesus."

When my mind wanders off, I go get it back. "I love You, Jesus."

When I was learning how to worship, I came to the place where I would not disrespect my King by having my mind somewhere else while I stood there doing lip service. Out of respect for my King, I use protocol. When I am in His presence, I give Him the respect of having all of me.

I would rather say "I love You" and pour everything I am into those three words than think up a flowery array of words I think might please Him. What pleases Him is when you worship Him with all your heart, mind, soul, and strength.

I stay there until I accomplish that.

Usually I have three phrases: "I love You. I worship You. I praise You, Jesus."

It is not empty repetition. Even if it were repetition, it would not be heathen repetition. It belongs to God. It ministers to your soul over and over until transformation takes place.

After a while, your soul begins to line up and come into order. It is not very long before He comes.

As I pour everything I am into each statement of adoration, pretty soon He comes. I know He comes because of the order of the Godhead.

When you have a petition or confession to make before God, this is the order: the Holy Spirit brings you into the presence of Jesus. Jesus said the Spirit would not speak of Himself, but would glorify Jesus.

The Holy Spirit's ministry is to glorify Jesus in your presence and lead you into His presence. When you begin glorifying Jesus and worshiping Him with the adoration of your entire soul, the Holy Spirit glorifies Him.

After I get into Jesus' presence through worship, Jesus takes me by the arm and brings me into the presence of the Father.

How do I know He comes? Because when the Holy Spirit begins to glorify and magnify Jesus, you feel His presence. Sometimes it gets so strong you get lost in it and do not want to come out.

His presence is amplified in your soul. Your senses detect Him. The atmosphere is charged. Your spirit and soul are on go. Half an hour earlier it was a chore to enter in; now someone would have to hit you with a hammer to get you to stop.

At times God graces us in a service and comes like that. He sweeps through, and some of you dance. Some of you are not outwardly expressive, but I can tell by watching your fingers that you are being moved as far as you can be moved.

If God wanted you to dance like a wild man up front and moved on you to do it, you would be ahead to obey Him.

Someone says, "But I am not that kind of person."

Maybe He does not want you to remain a reserved, stuck-in-the-corner, afraid-to-obey-Him kind of person.

You can tell when the Holy Spirit is amplifying Jesus' presence and glorifying Him in our midst. You can also tell when He is not. Sometimes everyone is trying, but the atmosphere feels dead and heavy.

The devil fights worship sometimes. You might as well dismiss and go home as far as you are getting with it if nobody enters in and everyone just sits politely because they know they are supposed to.

Faithfulness must be faithfulness to the right thing. Otherwise you may even destroy what others build up. Paul called misdirected zeal beating the air.

The devil knows how to handle zealous people who refuse to stay with the Word and refuse to know God through worship and speaking His Word. He deceives them into burning their energy on something that will not make any difference.

That is why the Holy Ghost lives for the day you get to know Him through praying in tongues and worship, and for the day you offer your soul on the altar of assimilation to God's Word.

Sometimes when the Holy Spirit comes in a service, He does not come because the people are so prepared. He often comes because the worship team is prepared and the message preached is strong enough to hammer back unbelief and the affairs of the day.

God has made me know that those strong manifestations do not have to be only moves of grace to pick us up when we have been dry too long. He does not want His presence to be like a gift of the Spirit that simply says, "Poor thing, go home happy."

We can enter into that presence all the time when people know how to worship by pouring their whole soul into every statement of adoration.

Who cares about the visitor standing next to you? When that time of the service comes, pour yourself into that atmosphere. Why make the effort to get dressed and come down here if you are not going to milk every statement of worship?

I enter His presence with worship. I love to do that any time I can. I am not singing to you or for you. Jesus Christ is my only audience. Nobody has to pump me up. I am in His presence.

It is not necessarily how loud you are, but how much of your soul you collect and pour into every statement: "Oh Jesus, how I love You."

He will come. The Holy Ghost will glorify Him, speak of Him, and reveal Him. When the King is present, so is soul healing. You may not leave defeated in that business deal. You may not leave without your rent being paid. You may not leave with the pain that was in your body, because the King came.

When Jesus comes, I have no trouble worshipping or confessing His Word. It begins to be led.

"I worship You. I glorify You. I praise You, Jesus. You are not a man that You can lie. You have exalted Your Word above Your name. Heaven and earth will pass away before Your Word fails to come to pass. Therefore I have what I say, and I say I have my petition that I ask of You."

The Holy Spirit leads me into Jesus' presence, and Jesus leads me into the presence of the Father. That is where I present my petition and confession.

Many times I first start by praying in tongues and worshiping. I may pray in tongues for forty-five minutes or an hour, then go into solid worship for about an hour. Pretty soon He comes. When He comes, I stay in His presence and worship Him.

Then I begin the kind of confession born out of worship:

"Jesus, You are not a man that You can lie. I thank You and praise You that by grace You took my standing of poverty and gave me Yours. You acquired all of my debt. You literally took my poverty and gave me Your standing by an act of grace. You incurred my debt. I have Your standing. I am rich because You incurred my debt."

That is a spiritual thing.

When I first began to attain to it, incredible feelings of wealth passed through my spirit. I felt like I could take anything and convert it to money. I saw opportunity everywhere I looked. I felt incredibly rich, and I did not realize it was the spiritual force of the standing He had given me by grace rising up on the inside of me.

That standing is good to meet any need I ever incur for the Kingdom of God's sake. He assimilates your poverty and gives you His standing.

You can come to a place where no one, neither the devil nor anything else, can convince you that Jesus has not incurred your debt and that He will not take care of you.

That spiritual force administered by grace will not only make millions for you, it will give millions through you. It turns you into a giver.

The only reason a person is not a giver is because he was giving while trying to get rich. When that broke down, fear came. You have to become rich first in the spirit. Then giving is born out of being rich. Giving does not create the standing of being rich. It is born out of the standing, and that comes from fellowship and relationship.

Before confession became confession, it was first presented as petition. God knows what is in your petition long before you present it. You can sneak toward the prayer closet with your petition hidden under your shirt, but He already knows what is in it.

Matthew 6 says your Father knows what you need before you pray. Then Jesus says, "After this manner therefore pray ye." The Lord's Prayer becomes a prerequisite to your petition being answered.

If the prerequisites are not in your life, you might as well fold the petition up.

Someone says, "I was going to ask for a new car."

Let us talk about this:

Hallowed be thy name.

Thy kingdom come.

Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven.

Give us this day our daily bread.

And forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors.

Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil.

Have you consecrated your life wholly to His will being fulfilled in the earth? Are you forgiving those indebted to you? Are you following Him?

What makes a person think he can live a rebellious life any way he wants and then run around speaking millions into his pocket?

I want to know Him. I want that spiritual standing of Him incurring my debt, the same way He incurred my sin and made me righteous, the same way He incurred my sicknesses and pains so I do not have to carry them, the same way the chastisement of my peace was laid on Him.

He would not open His mouth and defend Himself before Pilate, although He had all the wisdom that could be had. He would not defend Himself so that when the devil puts you on trial for what Jesus has delivered you from, you can open your mouth in substitution and give the wisdom He would not give.

The substitution and identification go on and on. Every one is a position in the Spirit that you have to be transformed to.

The whole heart of 1 John is that if you are born again, the path it will take you is into loving people. If you are going the other way, into hatred, that is not the evidence of the rebirth.

One of the highest and most honorable places God can bring you is a place where you will not hurt others. I am not talking about correction and instruction. I am talking about the delight, the vindication a person feels over another person's destruction.

When Jesus taught about forgiveness and offense, He said that if you offend a little one, you have offended Him. He began with the question of who is greatest in the Kingdom and ended with forgiveness. He taught about little children, purging, and removing whatever offends.

He wound the chapter up by showing who is greatest in the Kingdom, who demands the corporate respect of all the heavenlies, angels, and the Lord Jesus Christ: the person in this lifetime who created a capacity to forgive his brother every trespass against him.

That demands the most respect.

The book by Rick Joyner about heaven said heaven had the least respect for hypocrites: those holding a place of respect in the eyes of people while being something else in private life.

Let us read John 16:13:

Howbeit when he, the Spirit of truth, is come, he will guide you into all truth...

You have to be willing to be guided.

Jesus says:

...for he shall not speak of himself; but whatsoever he shall hear, that shall he speak: and he will shew you things to come.

He shall glorify me: for he shall receive of mine, and shall shew it unto you.

All things that the Father hath are mine...

The Holy Spirit's ministry is to take you into the presence of Jesus by glorifying Him in you and in worship. I can always tell when He comes. Sometimes in private worship it takes a while, but after a while He comes.

Now look at verse 23:

And in that day ye shall ask me nothing.

Jesus is talking about a change of covenants. That day is your day. You are in it.

Verily, verily, I say unto you, Whatsoever ye shall ask the Father in my name, he will give it you.

Hitherto have ye asked nothing in my name: ask, and ye shall receive, that your joy may be full.

Up until then, who did they run to? Jesus. But He says, "In that day you will ask Me nothing. You will ask the Father in My name."

Then He says:

At that day ye shall ask in my name: and I say not unto you, that I will pray the Father for you:

For the Father himself loveth you, because ye have loved me, and have believed that I came out from God.

The Holy Spirit leads me into Jesus' presence. Then Jesus brings me into the presence of the Father, and I ask in His name. The Father Himself hears me because I love Jesus.

God loves you so much that He took the question of blessing out of arbitrary sovereignty and put the starting gate at the Cross for every human being. The Cross has provided every spiritual blessing in heaven and earth.

He loves humanity so deeply that it took two members of the Godhead to undo what Adam and Satan did: one to become humanity and shed His blood, and the Holy Spirit to come and do the work. The Father planned it and got us out of it with His character intact. He is not God the destroyer. He is God the Redeemer.

He loves you because you love Jesus, the One who put you back into fellowship with Him. So when you enter His presence holding that name and ask Him something, you can believe He will do it.

If you believe Him, you will enter worship and fellowship with extended glory and praise for hearing you. If you do not believe it, you probably will not.

You are going to be handling the most powerful thing in the universe: His Word.

Jesus said:

Heaven and earth shall pass away, but my words shall not pass away.

When the elements pass away with fervent heat, anything temporary you built will burn. You may say, "I used my billions to build an empire, cities the size of New York." In heaven, you will be the beggar if that is all you built, because it all burns.

What did you send ahead?

Every soul you sent to heaven, every act of mercy, every extended hour of prayer and the results it brought, every dollar invested, and the secrets of men's hearts are on record. Paul said that in that day men will be judged according to his gospel.

I would be assimilating the Word of God. I would want to find out what He wants from me.

You are going to speak, but actually God is going to be speaking, because all He desires is a mouth to speak what He speaks.

Pick a difficult relative and put him in there today. Watch God track him down. Ask Him to let you know what is happening, and watch. Somebody will come, some old relative will call and say, "You know so-and-so is related to you, aren't they? I do not know what is happening, but they seem to be getting religion."

He will make sure you find out.

Stand up.